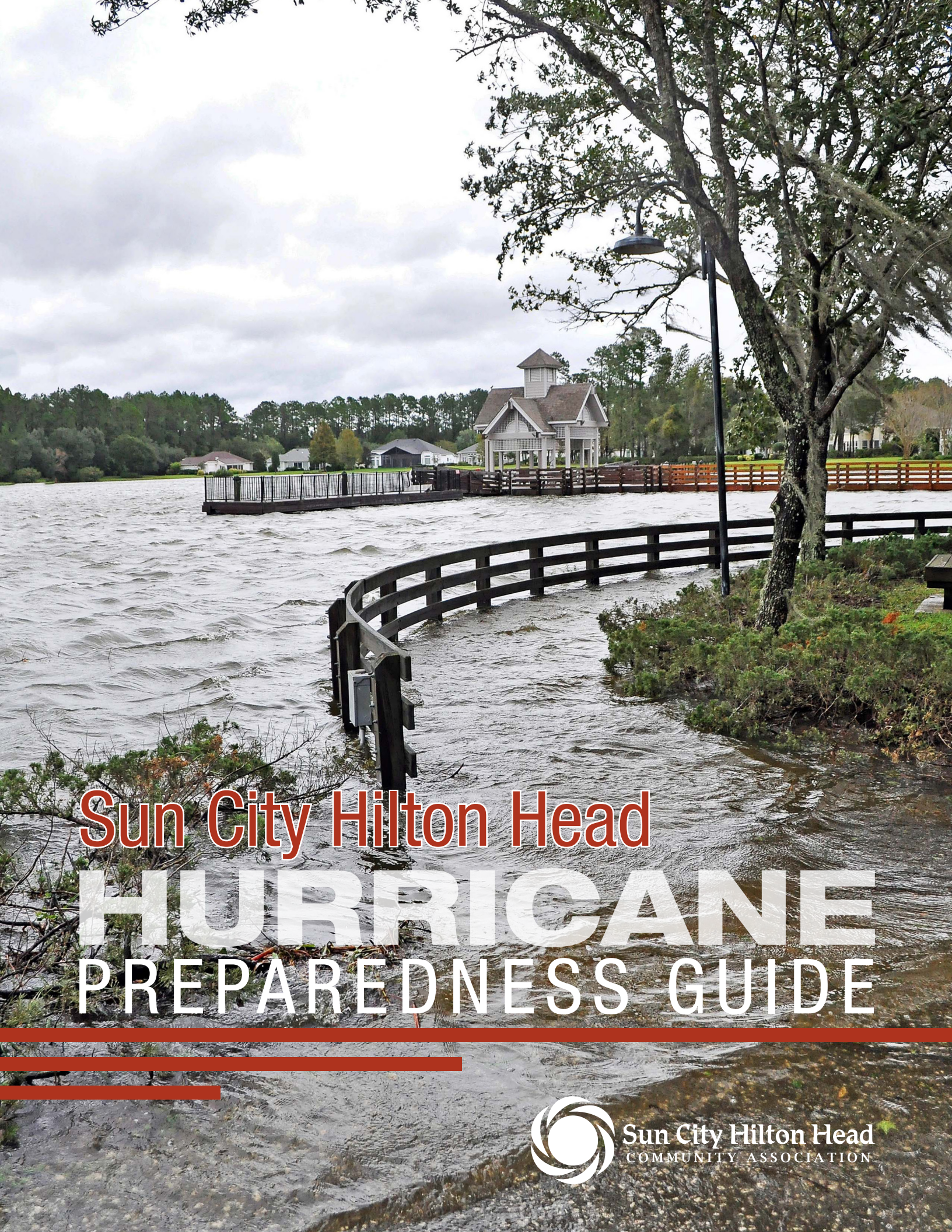




Sun City Hilton Head

HURRICANE PREPAREDNESS GUIDE



Sun City Hilton Head
COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION

Sun City Hilton Head

HURRICANE

PREPAREDNESS GUIDE

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Use this guide to help you prepare for the worst, with the hope that it never happens.

INTRODUCTION

The Atlantic hurricane season is June 1 through November 30.

In October 2016, Sun City Hilton Head experienced its first hurricane in its 21-year history when the Lowcountry was struck by Hurricane Matthew. Aside from some flooding, downed trees and extensive damage at the Nature Trail, Sun City was mostly spared the devastation seen in most of Beaufort and Jasper counties. However, it was a stark reminder of the serious threat hurricanes pose to this slice of paradise.

A hurricane is a tropical cyclone that is accompanied by thunderstorms and a counterclockwise circulation of winds that can reach 75 mph or higher. Hurricane intensity is measured in categories 1-5, with 5 being the strongest.

As much damage as Hurricane Matthew caused as a Category 2 hurricane, it could have been much more devastating. Hurricanes can cause tornadoes, flooding and storm surges that can result in catastrophic property damage, financial loss and injuries. Even a tropical storm can cause destruction and prompt an evacuation of the area.

Weather experts are able to track the development and path of hurricanes and tropical storms, allowing us plenty of time to prepare and leave. The Community Association has a plan to protect the assets of the community. We hope residents will take the same precautions to protect themselves, their loved ones and their property. Do not wait until a hurricane is on its way; planning ahead is the only way to ensure the safety of your family, pets and property.

Much of the information in this guide comes from the Federal Emergency Management Agency (FEMA), www.fema.gov and www.ready.gov; the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Agency (NOAA), www.noaa.gov; The National Hurricane Center (NHC), www.nhc.noaa.gov; local emergency management officials and the South Carolina Emergency Management Division, www.scemd.org.

✓ YOUR DISASTER SUPPLY KIT

Long before the threat of a storm looms, it is best to have a disaster supply kit assembled. Make sure you have enough supplies to last you and your family seven days. Use this disaster supply checklist to make sure you have everything you need in case you must evacuate in a hurry.

MONEY AND PERSONAL DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Cash or traveler's checks
- ☐ Photo ID and/or driver's license
- ☐ Insurance policy information
- ☐ Phone directory
- ☐ Copies of personal and family records

MEDICATIONS

- ☐ First aid kit
- ☐ Four-week supply of prescription medications
- ☐ Prescription information
- ☐ Other needed medical equipment

FOOD AND WATER

- ☐ Nonperishable food to last seven days for humans and pets
- ☐ Can opener and eating utensils
- ☐ At least one gallon of water per person

SANITATION

- ☐ Personal hygiene and toiletry items

CLOTHING

- ☐ Enough clothing to last seven days per person
- ☐ Protective clothing
- ☐ Sturdy shoes

ELECTRONICS

- ☐ Fully charged cell phone and chargers
- ☐ Battery-operated radio and spare batteries
- ☐ NOAA Weather Radio All Hazards (NWR), a nationwide network of radio stations broadcasting continuous weather from the National Weather Service

OTHER USEFUL ITEMS

- ☐ Matches in a waterproof container
- ☐ Insect repellent
- ☐ Road map with directions to evacuation locations
- ☐ Pocket knife
- ☐ Blankets and pillows
- ☐ Extra gas can

This kit should be stored somewhere that is easily accessible. Make sure everyone in your family knows where the kit is located if you need to quickly leave during an evacuation.



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PREPARING FOR THE HURRICANE

Get Ready Now

Do not wait for the storm warnings to start before you think about your hurricane plans. Take these simple steps now so you are ready if severe weather is headed our way.

- Build your disaster supply kit.
- Identify evacuation locations.
- Make sure your home and yard are in good condition and prepared to weather heavy rains and strong winds.
- Know how to install your hurricane shutters.
- Make sure you have the necessary insurance policies and inventory your belongings in case you need to make a claim.

Preparing for an Evacuation

You may need to leave quickly if the governor issues an evacuation order. Take these steps to make sure you are ready to leave as soon as possible.

- Call ahead to hotels to make reservations or contact family and friends to prepare them for your arrival.
- Choose locations that are inland and have several options available as hotel rooms may quickly fill up.
- Have a plan in place to stay in touch with family and loved ones.

Special Assistance

Residents who require special assistance must plan ahead in the event of an evacuation. The Community Association is not responsible for the evacuation of homeowners. Speak to friends who might be willing to assist you or contact these other local sources:

Beaufort County Emergency Management
(843) 255-4000

Jasper County Emergency Management
(843) 726-7607

Pet Safety

Your pets are family members too! Do not forget to have a plan in place for pets if a hurricane strikes. Here are some things to consider:

Assemble a pet disaster supply kit. Include medications, medical records, leashes, carriers, food, water, beds, toys, litter boxes, etc.

Make sure pets are microchipped or wearing collars with a current ID. Be aware most shelters do not allow pets. For more information, contact:

Beaufort County Animal Shelter & Control
(843) 255-5010

Jasper Animal Rescue Mission
(843) 726-7799

Before the Hurricane

Community Association Responsibility

When a hurricane evacuation is issued, remember that Community Association employees will also be leaving town. Here is what the Community Association will do in the event of a hurricane evacuation:

- Secure Community Association property.
- Close all amenities and pools.
- Share updates regarding property closures within Sun City.
- Fuel Community Association equipment and vehicles.

Resident Responsibility

Please remember that it is your responsibility to properly prepare your personal affairs and property in the event of a hurricane. Here are a few primary resident responsibilities:

- Plan where to go and transportation to get there.
- Install storm shutters prior to a storm.
- Help neighbors who require special assistance.



Sun City Hilton Head HURRICANE PREPAREDNESS GUIDE

You will likely be inundated with information from county officials and local media outlets in the days leading up to a hurricane. It is important to understand what kind of updates to expect from each source and where to look for the news you need to know about the community.

The Community Association will provide updates regarding the hurricane's impact on Sun City only.

How the Community Association Will Communicate

Email Updates

Make sure you opt-in to email communication from the Community Association. Log into www.SunCityHiltonHead.org to opt-in.

Web Updates

Posts to www.SunCityHiltonHead.org will be public so that your family can check on the community, too.

What the Community Association Will Communicate

- When amenities will close
- When the community will close
- When staff will depart
- When Sun City will reopen
- Recovery updates
- Reopening of amenities
- Information about clean-up processes and procedures

Sign Up For Everbridge/Nixle

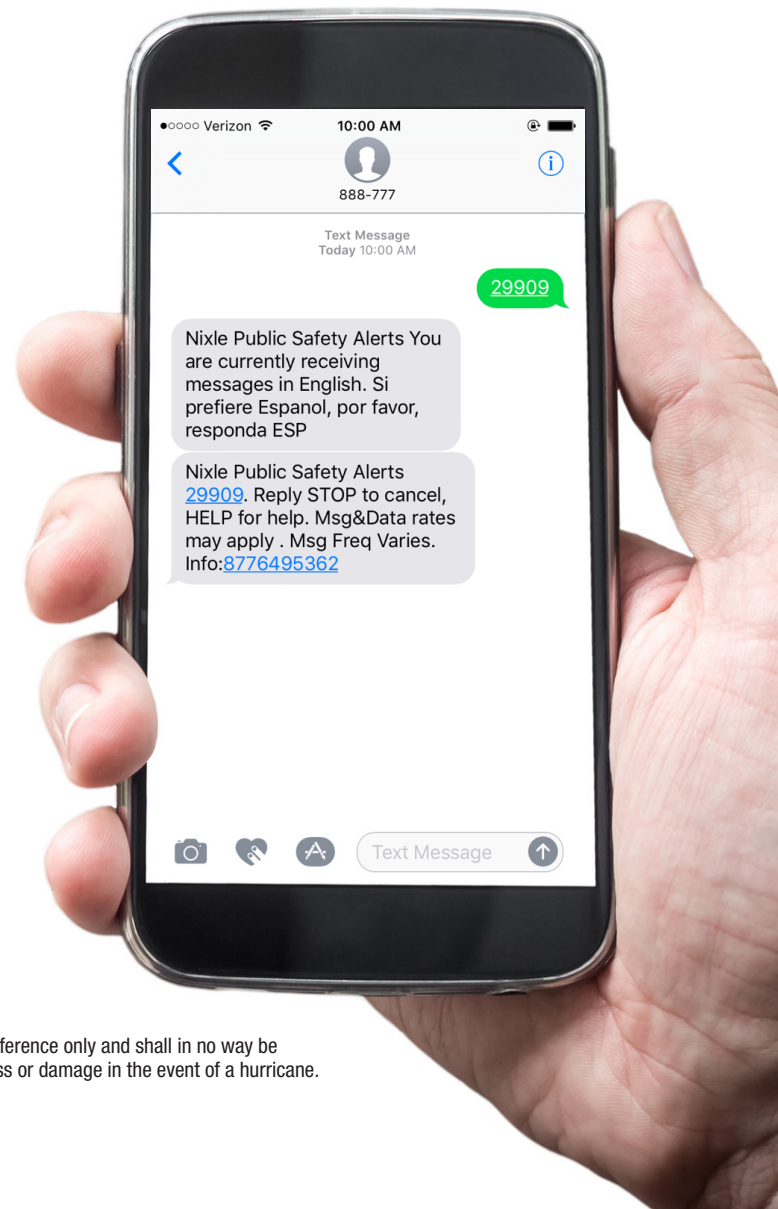
Text your zip code to 888777

Beaufort County Sheriff's Office, Jasper County Sheriff's Office and the city of Hardeeville all use a program called Everbridge/Nixle to send text message alerts about severe weather, criminal activity, traffic conditions and more. Subscribe to this service to find out what is happening outside the gates, especially during a tropical storm or hurricane event.

Consider the Source

Always get your hurricane information from reliable news sources or from government authorities. Social media can contain many rumors or false information, or information that is not relevant to Sun City or Beaufort or Jasper counties.

For information about the weather, traffic conditions outside the community, and news from Beaufort or Jasper counties, please see the list of news sources on the next page.



Sources of Information

Beaufort County

Beaufort County Sheriff's Office Storm Center
<https://bcso.net/storm-center/>
Beaufort County Sheriff's Office Facebook Page:
<https://www.facebook.com/BeaufortCountySheriffsOfficeSC>

Jasper County

Jasper County: <https://www.jaspercountysc.gov>
Jasper County Sheriff's Office: <https://jcso.net/>
Jasper County Sheriff's Office Facebook Page:
<https://www.facebook.com/JasperCountySheriff>

State

South Carolina Emergency Management Division (SCEMD): www.scemd.org
Facebook: www.facebook.com/SCEMD
Twitter: www.twitter.com/SCEMD
SC Emergency Manager App: Free from the Apple App Store and Google Play store.
Department of Transportation Travel Information: 511

Weather

National Hurricane Center (NHC)
www.nhc.noaa.gov
National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA): www.noaa.gov

Local Radio Stations

South Carolina Public Radio: 89.9 FM
GPB Radio: 91.1 FM
Hot 98.3: 98.3 FM
The River: 98.7 FM
SC 103.1: 103.1 FM
Rock: 106.1 FM
BOB: 106.9 FM

Local TV News Stations

WSAV Channel 3: www.wsav.com
WTOG Channel 11: www.wtog.com
WJCL News: www.wjcl.com
Follow these TV stations on Facebook and Twitter for regular updates.

Local Newspapers

Island Packet: www.islandpacket.com
Bluffton Today: www.blufftontoday.com
Savannah Morning News: www.savannahnow.com
Follow these publications on Facebook and Twitter for regular updates.



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Evacuation: Leave Early

The South Carolina governor may issue an evacuation order for certain counties based on the projected track of the hurricane. If a storm threatens the coastline, stay tuned to local news outlets and government agencies to find out if an evacuation order is issued for the area and for further instructions.

One of the most important things to remember about an evacuation is to leave early! Do not wait until right before the storm hits as you could be stuck in traffic for hours. Plan to leave during daytime hours and let someone know where you are going. After you leave the community, you may be required to follow the South Carolina Highway Patrol’s evacuation traffic pattern. Make sure you know how to get to your evacuation location.

If the governor has not yet issued an evacuation order but the storm is heading our way, consider leaving the area to stay ahead of traffic.

During an evacuation order, all inbound gates into Sun City will remain open. If you leave the property, you may be subject to follow evacuation routes set by local authorities, which means you may be prevented entry into Sun City.

**Emergency Shelters:
A Last Resort**

Public emergency shelters will open if an evacuation is ordered. Shelters should be a last resort when considering an evacuation location. Shelters often do not accept pets due to health regulations. If you plan to use a shelter, bring the following items:

- Change of clothing (enough for several days)
- Linens (pillows, blankets, sheets and towels)
- Any necessary prescription medications
- Entertainment and/or comfort items
- Food and water

Get Out of Harm’s Way

There will be no Community Association or emergency services available after an evacuation order is issued. Residents are not advised to “ride out” a hurricane. Hurricanes can also bring severe weather conditions such as tornadoes and flooding that could lead to dangerous situations and injuries. Security will not be on the property, and it is possible that all the local hospitals will be closed until authorities deem the area safe for return. Depending on the storm’s impact, it could be several days before hospitals are open and emergency services are available again.

✓ **Last-Minute
Preparations**

TAKE THESE FINAL STEPS RIGHT BEFORE YOU EVACUATE:

- ☐ Secure outdoor objects like porch furniture, grills, garbage cans, etc.
- ☐ Fill bathtubs with water.
- ☐ If you have a swimming pool, cover the pump filter.
- ☐ Remove perishable food from refrigerators.
- ☐ Turn off any outdoor propane tanks.
- ☐ Disconnect all power cords to electronics.
- ☐ Turn off the water and shut off the valve.
- ☐ Place family mementos or valuables in the dishwasher, which will remain dry in the event of flooding.
- ☐ Leave a message on your answering machine so relatives and friends know when you left and where you are going.
- ☐ Cancel all vendor appointments as vendor access to the community ends three hours before an evacuation order goes into effect.

IN ADDITION TO YOUR DISASTER SUPPLY KIT, MAKE SURE YOU HAVE:

- ☐ A full tank of gas in your car
- ☐ Cash and credit cards. ATMs and banks will be closed in the event of a major storm, and businesses may not be able to process credit cards if power is out.
- ☐ Photo ID and/or driver’s license
- ☐ Homeowners or renters insurance policy, name of agent and telephone number
- ☐ The address, email and telephone number of your evacuation location

Sun City Hilton Head

HURRICANE

PREPAREDNESS GUIDE

Re-entry: Pack Your Patience

After the storm, it is crucial that you stay put until you hear otherwise from local authorities. Please be patient. While Sun City may have dodged the worst of the storm, other areas of the county may not have been so lucky – or vice versa. County officials may prevent all citizens from returning until the entire county is safe enough to travel, regardless of the condition of your neighborhood.

Ignoring instructions from county officials could leave you stranded at road blocks. It also distracts law enforcement and emergency management officials from preparing the county for re-entry. Please be patient and remain away from the county until authorities reopen the entire area.

Do not return to Sun City based on what you see on social media from your friends and other residents. Only take re-entry instructions from emergency management authorities.

RETURNING TO SUN CITY



The Chain for Re-entry:

Only state and/or county officials can decide to reopen Beaufort or Jasper counties after a storm. **After that decision is made, the Community Association will decide when to reopen Sun City.**

Watch from communication from the association to find out if the community has been cleared for re-entry.

Prep Tip: Before your return to Sun City, consider stopping and purchasing items you may find in short supply when you get home, such as food, water, cleaning supplies, medicine, box fans, dehumidifiers, etc.

During Re-entry

Community Association Responsibility

- Some essential staff will return to the property as soon as possible to assess damage and begin clean up.
- Staff will restore amenities and services as quickly as possible, depending on the extent of the damage.
- **The Community Association cannot check on residents' personal property.**

Resident Responsibility

- Stay informed via verified local news outlets about when to return.
- Check on neighbors' property until they return.
- Clean up of storm debris around your personal property.
- Help neighbors who require special assistance with cleanup.



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Sun City Hilton Head HURRICANE PREPAREDNESS GUIDE

Please continue to remain calm and patient during the recovery process, and do not expect it to be quick or easy. You could be kept out of your neighborhood for several days or weeks, depending on the extent of the damage. When you are allowed back into your home, it could take time for relief assistance to start and for all utilities to be turned on. It will also take some time for the Community Association to restore Sun City back to normal. Amenities may be closed for several days, even if damage is not severe, because staff need to evaluate the integrity of all the buildings. Services will also be limited as staff return from an evacuation. Keep in mind staff also need to attend to their families and homes. Be patient.

Clean Up Following Return

Please be cautious with food, sanitation and electricity. Consult local news outlets or the Beaufort-Jasper Water & Sewer Authority to determine if water is safe to drink. For questions and information about electricity, gas and sewer services and safety after a storm, please refer to your appropriate utility provider.

Beaufort-Jasper Water & Sewer Authority

Customer Service: (843) 987-9200

Website: www.bjwsa.org

Facebook: www.facebook.com/BJWSA

Dominion Energy South Carolina

Customer Service: 1-800-251-7234

Website: <https://www.dominionenergy.com/south-carolina>

Facebook: www.facebook.com/dominionenergy

Palmetto Electric Cooperative

Customer Service: 1-800-922-5551

PowerTouch: 1-866-445-5551

Website: www.palmetto.coop

Facebook: www.facebook.com/PalmettoElectricCoop

Hargray/Sparklight

Customer Service: 1-877-427-4729

Website: www.hargray.com

Spectrum

Customer Service: 1-833-267-6094

Website: www.spectrum.net/support

Facebook: www.facebook.com/Spectrum

Debris Clean Up: Stay tuned to eNews Weekly to find out how debris clean-up and pick-up will be handled in the aftermath of a storm.

Hurricane Shutter Removal: Hurricane shutters should be removed within 10 days after the threat of a storm has passed.

AFTER THE HURRICANE

After the Hurricane

Community Association Responsibility

- Employees will return to Sun City as soon as possible to assess damage.
- They will confirm Association buildings are secure, photograph damage for insurance purposes, clear debris from roadways, begin repairs, and clean up amenities and common areas.
- Staff will notify residents about debris clean-up procedures.

Resident Responsibility

- Remove limbs, leaves, brush, tree trunks and other yard waste from your private property. The Community Association **is not** responsible for common area trees that fall on private lots. The removal of trees is the individual homeowner's responsibility.
- Assist neighbors with clean-up, if possible.

Other Safety Tips in the Aftermath

- Be careful when walking around outdoors and watch out for downed trees and power lines, debris and displaced animals such as snakes and alligators.
- Check structures before entering, and do not enter a building surrounded by floodwater.
- Do not walk through floodwater or drive through flooded roads.
- Wear rubber gloves and thick-soled shoes when cleaning to avoid infection from sewage or other contaminants.
- Take extra precaution with food in your refrigerator, especially if you lost power. Dispose of spoiled food in a sanitary manner. For more food safety information before and after a disaster, please visit www.foodsafety.gov.



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Left: Clean up at Purrysburg Fitness Center.
Photo by Bob Cragin.



If Beaufort and Jasper counties are declared disaster areas following a hurricane or other natural disaster, Sun City Emergency Guidelines will take effect. That means that Sun City's design and new construction guidelines will be modified so homeowners can get quicker approval to restore their homes to what they once were. All rebuilding approvals will also be subject to Beaufort and Jasper counties' permitting process. Check the county websites (Beaufort County: <https://www.beaufortcountysc.gov>; Jasper County: www.jaspercountysc.gov) for more information.

Plans For Architectural Review Board Guidelines

In case of a major disaster, the Modifications Committee has adopted procedures to expedite project review and approval.

- If you are replacing or rebuilding part of your property that was present prior to being destroyed, you do not need modifications approval to rebuild.
- You do need approval for any new additions or changes.

Since Sun City Hilton Head may not be fully accessible in the aftermath of a hurricane or natural disaster, Modifications Committee members will not be required to visit each site. Instead, members may review and approve design plans electronically sent to them at off-property locations. As always, the Modifications Committee and Community Association management intend to work closely and cooperatively with each landowner to restore a safe and secure living environment.

No approval is required:

To remove trees or for minor repairs. Homeowners must submit before and after pictures of the property and notify the Modifications Department in writing of the repairs to properly update files. These repairs include:

- Removing trees that have fallen on or across homeowner's property or homes, or are leaning more than 30 degrees;
- Minor roof repairs involving less than 50 percent of the total roof and garage surface. The roofing materials must match the original color and texture;
- Replacing broken windows with those that match the original window;
- Replacing less than 50 percent of all exterior wall materials with matching materials and repainting with pre-approved or an identical paint color;
- Replacing any damaged exterior doors or garage doors and repainting with a pre-approved or an identical paint color.

Approval from the Modifications Department is required for:

Restoring a damaged home to its state before the storm. In situations where property is going to be reconstructed virtually identical to the original home, including previously approved modifications, homeowners will have to sign and submit a Declaration Form for review. Repairs include:

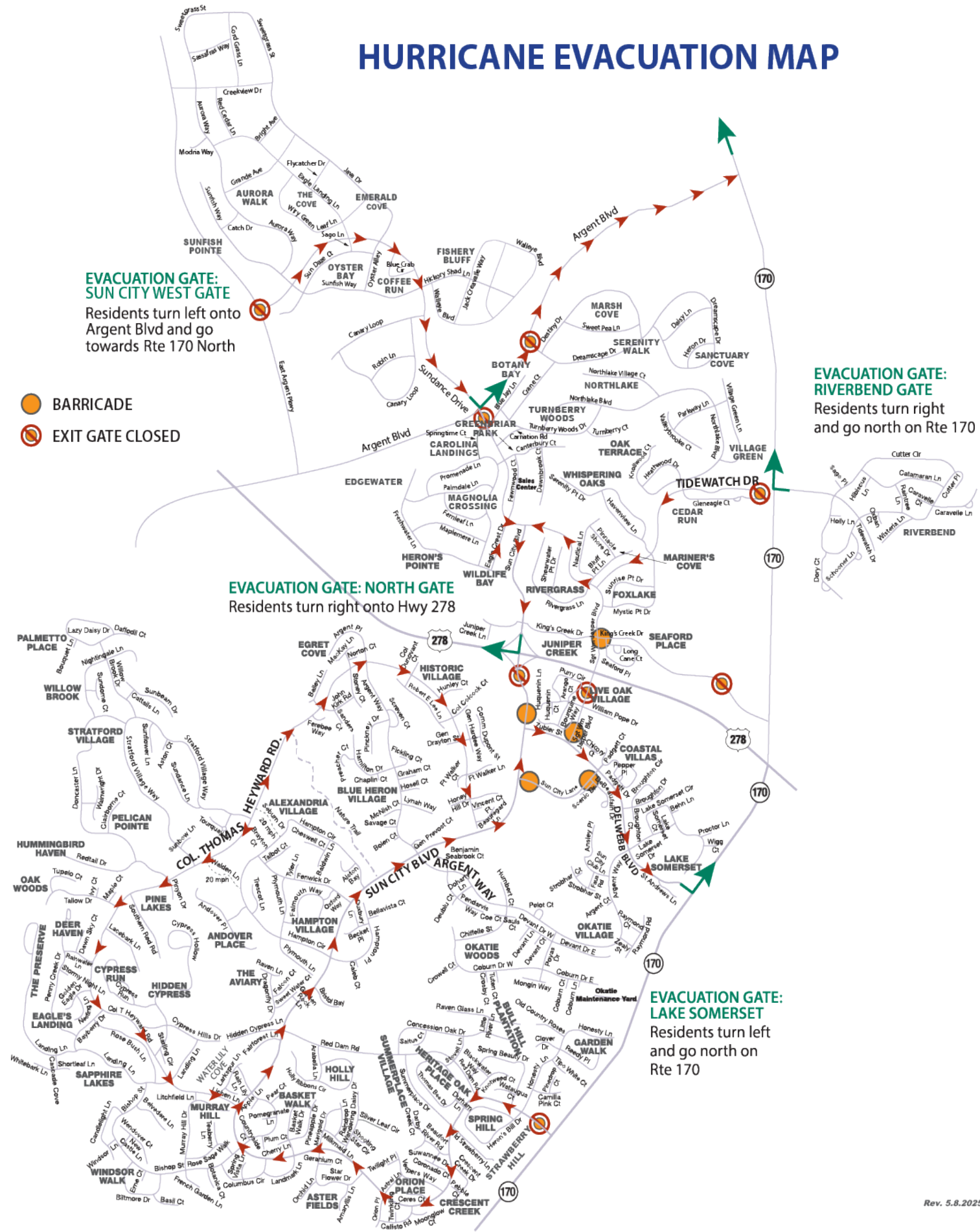
- Removing damaged trees from the homeowner's property;
- Replacing more than 50 percent of the roof or replacing any portion of the roof with a different but pre-approved color or texture roof;
- Replacing broken windows with a similar style;
- Replacing more than 50 percent of all exterior wall materials;
- Repainting exterior walls or exterior doors and garage doors with a different but pre-approved color.

Modifications/Emergency Reviewing Body Approval is required for:

Repairing extensive damage or rebuilding. In cases where the property needs to be substantially rebuilt and the property owner decides to change the design, size or exterior materials, the traditional application approval process will be required. This includes all proposed property improvements other than those listed above and changes such as raising the ground floor elevation, changing exterior wall material and color, or expanding or shrinking landscaping.



HURRICANE EVACUATION MAP



Evacuation

When Sun City Hilton Head is under an evacuation order, the only way to exit the community will be through the Lake Somerset Gate, North Gate, Riverbend Gate and Sun City West Gate.

All inbound gates will remain open during and after an evacuation. After exiting Sun City, you may be subject to evacuation routes set by local authorities.

Millennium Bridge will be closed during an evacuation to help with internal evacuation routes and for wind safety precautions.

Sun City Lane will be closed at the intersection of Sun City Blvd and Del Webb Blvd.

Residents living in neighborhoods south of Hwy. 278

Follow the traffic pattern shown in the map when in Sun City and exit out of the Lake Somerset Gate. You will turn left onto S.C. 170 and follow it north to S.C. 462/I-95.

Residents living in neighborhoods north of Hwy. 278

Follow the traffic pattern shown in the map when in Sun City and exit out of the North Gate. You will turn right onto Hwy. 278 and follow it west to I-95.

Residents living north of Hwy. 278 in Sun City West

Exit out of the Sun City West Gate. You will turn left onto Argent Blvd. At the intersection of Argent Blvd and S.C. 170 you will turn left onto S.C. 170 and follow it north to S.C. 462/I-95.

Riverbend residents

Exit out of the Riverbend Gate. You will turn right onto S.C. 170 and follow it north to S.C. 462/I-95.

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[illegible]This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.



Revised May 2025